A GIFT OF FIRE THIRD EDITION - SARA BAASE
CHAPTER 2: PRIVACY

Lecture 2
"Big Brother is Watching You”

Md Umaid Hasan
Lecturer, Dept.of CSE
Daffodil International University

"BIG BROTHER IS WATCHING YOU"

- Databases:
  - Government agencies
    - Collect many types of information
    - Ask business to report about consumers
    - Buy personal information from sellers
  - Main publicized reason: data mining and computer matching to fight terrorism
  - Private information can be used to:
    - Arrest people
    - Jail people
    - Seize assets

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- Databases:
  - Millions of crime suspects are searched in government databases
  - Shift from presumption of innocence to presumption of guilt
  - Computer software characterizes suspects
    - Innocent people are sometimes subject to embarrassing searches and expensive investigations and to arrest and jail.

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Small Sampling of Government Databases with Personal Information

- What data does the government have about you?
  - Tax records
  - Medical records
  - Marriage and divorce records
  - Property ownership
  - Welfare records
  - School records
  - Motor vehicle records
  - Voter registration records
  - Books checked out of public libraries
  - People with permits to carry firearms
  - Applications for government grant and loan programs
  - Professional and trade licenses
  - Bankruptcy records
  - Arrest records

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- Some constitution articles (laws) protect privacy.
- Modern surveillance techniques are redefining expectation of privacy.
- In some countries:
  - No court order or court oversight needed to get one's private information.
  - 2003-2005 report found "widespread and serious misuse" of the FBIs (**Federal Bureau of Investigation**)national security letter authorities.

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Two key problems arise from new technologies:

- Much of our personal information is no longer safe in our homes; it resides in huge databases outside our control.
- New technologies allow the government to search our homes without entering them and search our persons from a distance without our knowledge

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Video Surveillance:

- Security cameras in Shopping centers, malls, banks, etc.
- Cameras alone raise some privacy issues.
- When being combined with face recognition systems, they raise more privacy issues.
  - Increased security
  - Decreased privacy

Thank You